UNIT 1: BEGINNING YOUR JOURNEY, CAREER READINESS ORIENTATION

TOPIC 6: INTERPERSONAL SKILLS

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Understand the importance of setting boundaries and how to set boundaries
- Understand that conflict can be positive if handled effectively
- Understand the benefits of negotiation
- Understand different team player styles

Topic OUTCOMES: The learner will:

- Set boundaries for herself/himself
- Create a conflict web
- Know their team player style

Topic ACTIVITIES:

I. Welcome to the Day

Opening Question:

- What was the best team you were ever a part of? What made it so great?
- What is one of your pet peeves (something that annoys you)? Why?
- What was the best (or worst) deal you ever got through a negotiation?

Opening Quotes:

- "You cannot shake hands with a clenched fist."
  ~ *Indira Ghandi* (India's only female prime minister)
- "The most basic of all human needs is the need to understand and be understood. The best way to understand people is to listen to them."
  ~ *Ralph Nichols* (English badminton player)
- "Proficiency in emotional management, conflict resolution, communication and interpersonal skills is essential for children to develop inner self-security and become able to effectively deal with the pressures and obstacles that will inevitably arise in their lives. Moreover, increasing evidence is illuminating that emotional balance and cognitive performance are indeed linked."
  ~ Research Overview (c) Institute of HeartMath
- "They may forget what you said, but they will never forget how you made them feel."
  ~ *Carl W. Buechner*
- "The most basic and powerful way to connect to another person is to listen. Just listen. Perhaps the most important thing we ever give each other is our attention."
  ~ *Rachel Naomi Remen* (medical reformer, holistic health, and educator)
- "Never expect people to treat you any better than you treat yourself."
  ~ *Bo Bennett* (businessman, author, motivational speaker, philanthropist)

Real-World Application Check-in:

- Ask participants to share observations and thoughts.

Overview of the Day

- Today we are going to be discussing four different aspects of interpersonal skills. Does anyone know what interpersonal skills are? (Interpersonal: being, relating to or involving relations between persons) http://www.merriam-webster.com/dictionary/interpersonal
- Interpersonal Skills are skills that have to do with how people relate to one another. Four skills we will explore today: Boundaries, Conflict Resolution, Negotiation, and Working on a Team.

II. Boundaries

Large Group Discussion

- What are boundaries? Why do we have/need boundaries? How do we know our boundaries?
- "The purpose of having boundaries is to protect and take care of ourselves. We need to be able to tell other people when they are acting in ways that are not acceptable to us. A first step is starting to know that we have a right to protect ourselves. That we have not only the right, but the duty to take responsibility for how we allow others to treat us." http://joy2meu.com/Personal_Boundaries.htm
- How do you set boundaries?
  - Communicate clearly.
  - Be specific.
  - One formula to use when someone crosses a boundary:
    - When you… I feel… I want…
    - Example: When you interrupt me (describe behavior), I feel unimportant, sad and angry (describe feelings). I want to know that you care about me and respect what I have to say (describe what you want).
    - If the behavior continues, you can add another statement. If you continue (describe behavior), I will (describe what you will do).
    - Setting boundaries is not about making threats or manipulating people — make sure you will follow through on what you say — setting healthy boundaries means being okay with whatever happens and being able to follow through with what you say. Making threats and not following through can create a dynamic where that boundary and other boundaries that you try to set might not be taken seriously.
- How are work boundaries set? Some boundaries are set by the organization (HR policies). Some boundaries are set by law. (sexual harassment, discrimination, etc.) Some boundaries are set by individuals.
- Practice setting boundaries.

  Have participants set 3-5 boundaries.

  Examples:
  - **(Work)** I am willing to help out and stay late at work when needed, but I can't stay late on Thursdays because I have to pick up my little sister from school.
  - **(Relationship)** I will listen to what you have to say, but I won't listen when you are yelling, swearing and/or being disrespectful.
  - **(Home — younger sibling)** I will let you borrow my stuff sometimes, but you have to ask permission before you borrow anything.

III. Conflict Resolution

- What is conflict? Create a Conflict Web
  Discuss the many different words people associate with conflict/use to describe conflict. How many are negative? How many are positive?
- Activity
  - Prior to Training write out the following on flip chart so everyone can see them throughout the activity.

    Activity Information to write out on flip chart:

    Goal of activity: Get as many points as you can

    Guidelines:

    1. *Do NOT hurt your partner.*
    2. *You get one point every time the back of your partner's hand touches the table.*
    3. *You have 45 seconds.*
  - Pair everyone up and arrange the partners so they are sitting across the table from each other.
  - Read the directions that are posted. Ask if there are any questions.
  - Have participants reach across the table with their right arm — elbow on the table — and grasp their partner's hand. (It will look like they are going to arm wrestle — but do not say 'arm wrestle'. Demonstrate what you mean if it is not clear.)
  - Time the 45 seconds and tell everyone to stop.
  - Discussion Questions:
    1. Raise your hand if you got more than five points. Ten points. Twenty points.
    2. What strategies did people use?
    3. Did anyone think to work with his/her partner? Did you actually work together? Why or Why not?
       If any of the pairs did work together, have them demonstrate — and then have everyone else see how many more points they can get working together (quickly going back and forth to get more points for both partners) than they got working against each other.
    4. How can this idea be applied to other areas of your life? Work?
    5. Our society is very competitive so often we see things as a competition, even when it does not have to be. How might this contribute to conflict?
    6. Did any of the directions say that this was a competition? Was your goal to get more points than your partner? Why did some people resist working together? Are there are other places we resist working with other people, even if it might help us reach our goals? Why?
    7. Conflict resolution is about finding a solution that works for everyone — where everyone 'wins'
- How do you deal with conflict?
  The five most common ways to deal with conflict are:
  - Avoid — not dealing with the conflict at all, pretending it does not exist
  - Accommodate — give in, do what the other party wants
  - Force — make the other party give in, use threats if necessary
  - Compromise — both parties give up something
  - Problem Solve — work together to find a solution that works for both parties "win-win" solution. Problem solving is usually the most effective, but it is also often the most difficult and time-consuming.
- The Positive Side of Conflict
  "If there is no struggle, there is no progress." ~ *Frederick Douglass*
  - Do you agree with this quote? Why or why not?
  - How could this quote relate to conflict?
  - What is the positive side of conflict?
  - What are some examples of the positive side of conflict? (Civil Rights, Women's Rights, The End of Slavery, etc.)

IV. Negotiation Skills

- Fairness in Negotiation Activity (directions included)
- Negotiation Discussion
  - What types of things do you negotiate? What types of things do people negotiate at work?
  - How do you feel when the negotiation does not go well?
  - What strategies do you use in your negotiations?
- Negotiation Tips
- The Benefits of Negotiation
  - Win-win strategies
  - Problem-solving (working together to find a solution that will work for both parties)
  - Relationship Building

V. Activity (Conflict Resolution and Working on a Team)

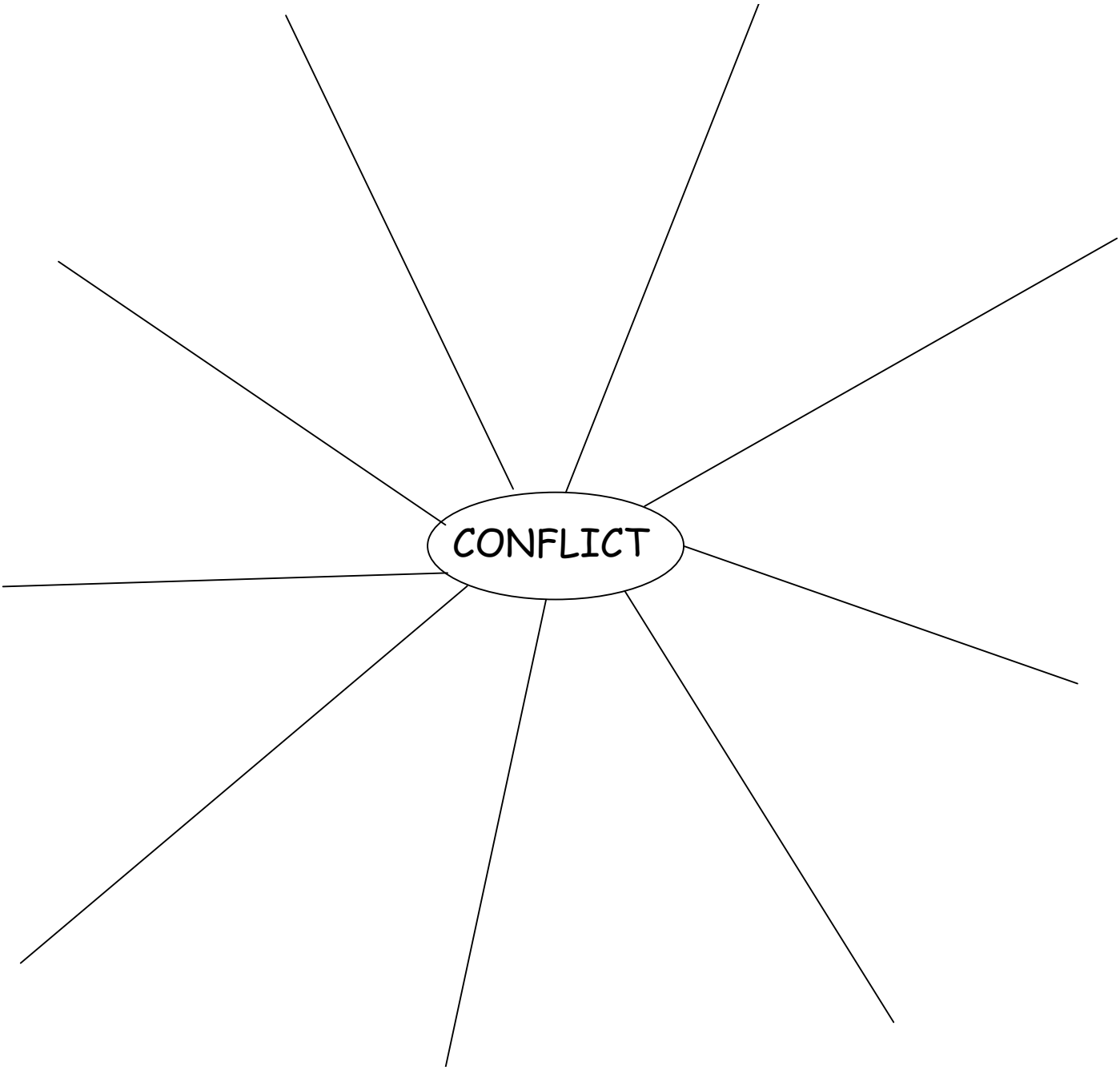
- Frenzy (directions included)

VI. Being a team player/Working on a team

- Complete the Team Player Survey (attached)
  - Who scored highest as a Contributor?
  - Who scored highest as a Collaborator?
  - Who scored highest as a Communicator?
  - Who scored highest as a Challenger?
  - Do you think the survey accurately describes your team 'style'? In what ways? Is there another style that describes you better? Which one? In what ways?
- Brainstorm the advantages and challenges of working on a team.
- In small groups, list the skills you need in order to work effectively on a team.
  - Which of these skills do you currently have?
  - Which ones are you learning?
  - Which ones do you need for work?
  - How can you improve the skills needed to work effectively on a team?

Real-World Application: Observe conflicts around you (at school, on the bus, in a store, at home, something you see on TV, etc.) How are they handled? Choose one and think about how it could have been handled better.

Conflict Web



Fairness of Negotiation

Objective: To stress the importance of perceptions of equity and fairness in any contract or negotiation.

Materials: A substantial supply of a tangible item that is likely to be mutually desirable by two persons present.

Procedure:

- Identify two people to role-play an interaction. Designate them A and B.
- Visibly provide Individual A with a supply of goods to distribute (to share with B). This may be $100 in (play) money, 100 jelly beans, or M&Ms. Instruct A that he or she is to make an offer to split the resource with B in any proportion desired. B may only accept or reject the offer, but not negotiate the split. If B accepts the offer, a deal is made. If B rejects the offer, neither party is to receive any of the items.
- Inform B that A has 100 of the resource items to be shared between them. B can accept or reject the single offer to be made, but may not provide any input into A's determination of the offer, nor may a counteroffer be made. If B rejects the offer, neither party keeps any of the items.
- Proceed with the role-play interaction.

Discussion Questions:

1. Why did A behave as she or he did?
2. Why did B respond as he or she did?
3. What advice do you have for people like A and B in these situations at work? At school? At home?

Thoughts:

A is often tempted to offer a split that will be personally favorable, such as 60-40 or 80-20. This reflects a world in which individuals compete for resources and are taught to "win" at all costs. From a rational perspective, B should accept any offer from A since B will be better off with anything (even 1). But since people don't like to be exploited, many B's will reject offers that don't seem fair (as perceived by them). Similarly, A could decide to offer any split (even 1-99), since that would make A better off than before. Apparently, the key to making a deal of this kind is not only to convince the other part that they will gain a lot but also to create an image of fairness, wherein B is convinced that A won't be gaining a lot more than B.

Even when it is possible to "make a killing" on a single deal, it would be wiser to build a long-term relationship by offering a fair deal. This requires, of course, either empathizing sufficiently to infer what is fair, or inquiring of the other party what would be a fair resolution to the situation.

If you have more time:

- After the first role-play, ask for new volunteers before discussing the incident, and then repeat the process.
- Repeat the process, allowing B to make a single counteroffer to A.

From **The Big Book of Business Games, Icebreakers, Creativity Exercises, and Meeting Energizers** By John Newstrom & Edward Scannell p 148

Negotiation Tips

Whether it's with an employer, family member or business, we all negotiate for things each day like a higher salary, better service or solving a dispute with a coworker or family member. Here are some negotiation skills, techniques and strategies to help you handle these situations more effectively.

1. Know Thyself: When you go into a negotiation, take a personal inventory. How do you feel about negotiation? Do you want to get it over fast? If so, you may give in too quickly, or give away too much. Or, do you want to win, no matter what the cost? If so, you may become adversarial and damage the relationship.

2. Do Your Homework: Know who you're negotiating with before you begin. What's his or her reputation as a negotiator? Win/Win model or Win/Lose model? Does the person want to negotiate with you (Oh Boy!), dread the negotiation (Oh No!), or is this a neutral situation (Show Me!).

3. Practice Double and Triple Think: It s not enough to know what you want out of negotiation. You also need to anticipate what the other party wants (double think). The smart negotiator also tries to anticipate what the other party thinks you want (triple think).

4. Build Trust: Negotiation is a highly sophisticated form of communication. Without trust, there won't be communication. Instead you'll have manipulation and suspicion masquerading as communication. Be trustworthy. Honor your commitments. Tell the truth. Respect confidences.

5. Develop External Listening: Most people carry on an inner dialogue with themselves. When you're trying to communicate with someone else, this inner dialogue becomes a problem because you can't listen internally and externally at the same time. When you negotiate, turn off your inner voice and only listen externally. You won't miss important nonverbal messages, facial expressions, or voice inflections when you listen externally.

6. Move Beyond Positions: It's risky to make yourself vulnerable to someone. That's why in a negotiation, you begin by stating your position. Later, when the trust has deepened, you and the other party can risk more honesty and identify your true interests. As a negotiator, it is your responsibility to ask questions that will uncover the needs or interests of the other party. If you've also done your job of creating a supportive climate, you're more likely to get honest answers.

7. Own Your Power: Don't assume that because the other party has one type of power (e.g. position power) that he or she is all-powerful. That's giving away your power! Balance power by assessing the other parties source(s) of power, and then your own. While there are many sources of power, they all break down into two categories; internal power and external power. The former no one can take away from you and includes your personal power, level of self-esteem, and self-confidence. External power fluctuates with your situation. If you're laid off or demoted, you can lose position power. If new technology is introduced, you can lose your expertise power. Because the dynamics of power are so changeable, a negotiation is never dead. Be patient; the power dynamics may shift.

8. Know Your BATNA: BATNA stands for Best Alternative to A Negotiated Agreement. The acronym comes out of the research on negotiation conducted by the Harvard Negotiation Project. Before you begin a negotiation, know what your options are. Can you walk away from the deal? What other choices do you have? What are the pros and cons of each choice? Don't stop here. Also consider the BATNA of the other party.

9. Know What a Win Is: What is your best case scenario? What is your worst case scenario? The area in between is called your settlement range. If you can reach an agreement within your settlement range, that's a Win! Don't drop below your bottom line; you'll feel bad about yourself and the deal afterwards, and you may not follow through on your commitments.

10. Enjoy the Process: Negotiation is a process, not an event. There are predictable steps – preparation, creating the climate, identifying interests, and selecting outcomes – that you will go through in any negotiation. With practice, you will gain skill at facilitating each step of the process. As your skill increases, you'll discover that negotiating can be fun.

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Frenzy

What: A relatively quick initiative that highlights the value of cooperation rather than competition.

Group Size: From 8-20.

Space Required: A large, relatively flat open space at least 30 square feet. Works indoors or out.

Time Required: 20 minutes.

Props Required: 5 Hula Hoops and 60-70 tennis balls.

Setup and Objective:

- Arrange 4 hula hoops on the ground spread out from each other at the four corners of an imaginary 25 foot square; place with the one in the middle (imagine the dots on the five sides of a dice).
- Place all tennis balls in the middle (neutral) hoop.
- Divide into four even teams. See the activity write-up for Categories for creative and fun ways to divide into teams — AVOID having 4 captains pick their people (were you ever picked last? I was…). Have each team pick a hula-hoop and stand by it.
- Explain the object of the game: each team is trying to place all of the tennis balls in its hoop; once you have all the balls, you win.

Rules:

- There is no throwing or tossing of the balls.
- All the balls must be out of the middle before you can take them from others hoops.
- No defending the hoops.

Facilitator Notes:

- Play will last for 3-5 minutes, at which point the participants will be out of breath and no nearer to winning. Signal a pause and ask them to regroup with their teams and strategize for two minutes. One group or another may come up with the creative solution (see step 3 below); most groups, however, will try to position the people "strategically," plan for faster ball transfers, etc. After two minutes, signal time, have them return to their starting positions, then Ready, Set, Go.
- After another fruitless 3-5 minutes, participants will still be no nearer to winning and starting to become a little frustrated. Signal another pause, and ask them to circle up as a group and perhaps "learn from each other." This will usually produce better results; if they need prodding, restate the object of the game and the rules. Some person will think to suggest that the groups work together; another might ask if the hoops can be moved (YES). In either event, you know that the group is on the right track.
- With some planning and thinking about what you've told them, they should realize that the only way to win (other than all of the other groups agreeing to lose — not likely) is for them all to win, (i.e., place all of the balls in the middle hoop, then place their hoops around the balls).

http://www.firststepstraining.com/resources/activities/archive/activity_frenzy.htm

The Team-Player Survey

Purpose

The Team-Player Survey will help you identify your style as a team player. The results will lead you to an assessment of your current strengths and provide a basis for a plan to increase your effectiveness as a team player.

Teams may use the survey to develop a profile of team strengths and to discuss strategies for increasing team effectiveness.

Directions

First, this is a survey, and, therefore, there are no right or wrong answers. Please answer each item according to how you honestly feel you function now as a team member rather than how you used to be or how you would like to be.

You will be asked to complete eighteen sentences. Each sentence has four possible endings. Please rank the endings in the order in which you feel each one applies to you. Place the number **4** next to the ending which is **most applicable** to you and continue down to a **1** next to the ending which is **least applicable** to you.

For example:

As a team member, I am usually most concerned about:

____ a. meeting high ethical standards.
____ b. reaching our goals.
____ c. meeting my individual responsibilities.
____ d. how well we are working together as a group.

Please do not make ties or use 4, 3, 2, or 1 more than once. It is possible that some of the sentences will have two or more endings that apply to you or will have none that apply to you, but you should assume these are your only choices and rank them accordingly. Each set of endings must be ranked 4, 3, 2, and 1. Remember, **4 = most applicable; 1 = least applicable.**

THE TEAM-PLAYER SURVEY

1. During team meetings, I usually:

____ a. provide the team with technical data or information.
____ b. keep the team focused on our mission or goals.
____ c. make sure everyone is involved in the discussion.
____ d. raise questions about our goals or methods.

2. In relating to the team leader, I:

____ a. suggest that our work be goal directed.
____ b. try to help him or her build a positive team climate.
____ c. am willing to disagree with him or her when necessary.
____ d. offer advice based upon my area of expertise.

3. Under stress, I sometimes:

____ a. overuse humor and other tension-reducing devices.
____ b. am too direct in communicating with other team members.
____ c. lose patience with the need to get everyone involved in discussion.
____ d. complain to outsiders about problems facing the team.

4. When conflicts arise on the team, I usually:

____ a. press for an honest discussion of the differences.
____ b. provide reasons why one side or the other is correct.
____ c. lose patience with the need to get everyone involved in discussions.
____ d. try to break the tension with a supportive or humorous remark.

5. Other team members usually see me as:

____ a. factual.
____ b. flexible.
____ c. encouraging.
____ d. candid.

6. At times, I am:

____ a. too results-oriented.
____ b. too laid-back.
____ c. self-righteous.
____ d. short-sighted.

7. When things go wrong on the team, I usually:

____ a. push for increased emphasis on listening, feedback, and participation.
____ b. press for a candid discussion of our problems.
____ c. work hard to provide more and better information.
____ d. suggest that we revisit our basic mission.

8. A risky team contribution for me is to:

____ a. question some aspect of the team's work.
____ b. push the team to set higher performance standards.
____ c. work outside my defined role or job area.
____ d. provide other team members with feedback on their behavior as team members.

9. Sometimes other team members see me as:

____ a. a perfectionist.
____ b. unwilling to reassess the team's mission or goals.
____ c. not serious about getting the real job done.
____ d. a nitpicker.

10. I believe team problem solving requires:

____ a. cooperation by all team members.
____ b. high-level listening skills.
____ c. a willingness to ask tough questions.
____ d. good, solid data.

11. When a new team is forming, I usually:

____ a. try to meet and get to know other team members.
____ b. ask pointed questions about our goals and methods.
____ c. want to know what is expected of me.
____ d. seek clarity about our basic mission.

12. At times, I make other people feel:

____ a. dishonest because they are not able to be as confrontational as I am.
____ b. guilty because they don't live up to my standards.
____ c. small-minded because they don't think long-range.
____ d. heartless because they don't care about how people relate to each other.

13. I believe the role of the team leader is to:

____ a. ensure the efficient solution of business problems.
____ b. help the team establish long-range goals and short-term objectives.
____ c. create a participatory decision-making climate.
____ d. bring out diverse ideas and challenge assumptions.

14. I believe team decisions should be based on:

____ a. the team's mission and goals.
____ b. a consensus of team members.
____ c. an open and candid assessment of the issues.
____ d. the weight of the evidence.

15. Sometimes I

____ a. see team climate as an end in itself.
____ b. play devil's advocate far too long.
____ c. fail to see the importance of effective team process.
____ d. overemphasize strategic issues and minimize short-term task accomplishments.

16. People have often described me as:

____ a. independent.
____ b. dependable.
____ c. imaginative.
____ d. participative.

17. Most of the time, I am:

____ a. responsible and hardworking.
____ b. committed and flexible.
____ c. enthusiastic and humorous.
____ d. honest and authentic.

18. In relating to other team members, at times I get annoyed because they don't:

____ a. revisit team goals to check progress.
____ b. see the importance of working well together.
____ c. object to team actions with which they disagree.
____ d. complete their team assignments on time.

TEAM-PLAYER SURVEY RESULTS

Directions:

1. Transfer your answers from the survey to the lines below.
2. Please be careful when recording the numbers because the order of the letters changes for each question. For example, in question #1, the order is a, b, c, d, but in question #2, the order is d, a, b, c.
3. The totals for the four styles must equal 180.

Question	"Contributor"	"Collaborator"	"Communicator"	"Challenger"
1.	a._____	b._____	c._____	d._____
2.	d._____	a._____	b._____	c._____
3.	c._____	d._____	a._____	b._____
4.	b._____	c._____	d._____	a._____
5.	a._____	b._____	c._____	d._____
6.	d._____	a._____	b._____	c._____
7.	c._____	d._____	a._____	b._____
8.	b._____	c._____	d._____	a._____
9.	a._____	b._____	c._____	d._____
10.	d._____	a._____	b._____	c._____
11.	c._____	d._____	a._____	b._____
12.	b._____	c._____	d._____	a._____
13.	a._____	b._____	c._____	d._____
14.	d._____	a._____	b._____	c._____
15.	c._____	d._____	a._____	b._____
16.	b._____	c._____	d._____	a._____
17.	a._____	b._____	c._____	d._____
18.	d._____	a._____	b._____	c._____
TOTALS	_____	_____	_____	_____ = 180

The highest number designates your primary team-player style. If your highest numbers are the same or within three points of each other, consider them both as your primary style. The lowest total indicates your least active team-player style.

Your primary team-player style defines a set of behaviors that you use most often as a member of a team. It does not mean that it is the only style you use. All of us have the capacity to use any one of the four styles. We simply use one style — our primary style — most often.

Contributor – Task

The contributor is a task-oriented team member who enjoys providing the team with good technical information and data, does his or her homework, and pushes the team to set high performance standards and to use their resources wisely. Most people see you as dependable, although they believe, at times, that you may become too bogged down in the details and data, or that you do not see the big picture or the need for positive team climate.

People describe you as responsible, authoritative, reliable, proficient, and organized.

Collaborator – Goal

The Collaborator is a goal-directed member who sees the vision, mission, or goal of the team as paramount but is flexible and open to new ideas, willing to pitch in and work outside his or her defined role, and able to share the limelight with other team members. Most people see you as a big-picture person, but they believe, at times, that you may fail periodically to revisit the mission, to give enough attention to the basic team tasks, or to consider the individual needs of other team members.

People describe you as forward-looking, goal directed, accommodating, flexible, and imaginative.

Communicator – Process

The Communicator is a process-oriented member who is an effective listener and facilitator of involvement, conflict resolution, consensus building, feedback, and the building of an informal, relaxed climate. Most people see you as a positive "people person, " but they find that, at times, you may see process as an end in itself, may not confront other team members, or may not give enough emphasis to completing task assignments and making progress toward team goals.

People describe you as supportive, considerate, relaxed, enthusiastic, and tactful.

Challenger – Question

The Challenger is a member who questions the goals, methods, and even the ethics of the team, is willing to disagree with the leader or higher authority, and encourages the team to take well-conceived risks. Most people appreciate the value of your candor and openness, but they think, at times, that you may not know when to back off an issue or that you become self-righteous and try to push the team too far.

People describe you as honest, outspoken, principled, ethical, and adventurous.

From *Team Players and Teamwork: The New Competitive Business Strategy* by Glenn M. Parker, The Jossey-Bass Management Series, 1990.